Graduate Site Engineer CV Guide

Your first construction CV - what to include when you have little or no site experience. Advisory guide; graduate scheme outcomes cannot be guaranteed.

What employers actually look for

- Evidence of site awareness and genuine interest in construction
- Health & safety understanding
- Relevant software: AutoCAD, Civil 3D, Revit, P6, Excel
- Practical projects (final-year project, group design work)
- Communication, reliability and willingness to learn

Structure (2 pages max, often 1-1.5)

1. Contact details
2. Profile: degree, target role, sector interest (3 lines)
3. Education: degree, key modules RELEVANT to the role, dissertation topic
4. Placements / work experience (any site exposure leads)
5. Projects: treat your final-year project like a job entry
6. Skills: software, surveying kit used, lab work
7. Other experience: part-time jobs (translated - see below)

Skills translation - the key trick (honest version)

- Retail/hospitality job -> working under pressure, customer/stakeholder communication
- Team captain / society role -> organisation, leadership evidence
- Dissertation -> research, analysis, report writing, presenting to assessors
- Group design project -> coordination, deadlines, technical compromise

Quick wins

- CSCS card (even before applying) signals seriousness
- Site visits, ICE student membership, attendance at talks - mention them
- One page of genuine evidence beats two pages of adjectives

Avoid

- Listing every module - pick the relevant ones
- "Passionate hard-working team player" without evidence
- Copying a template profile employers have read 500 times

Construct CV - Graduate / Junior Engineer Pack available on the website.